CLOUD & DEVOPS

Cloud Cost Optimization Visual Guide

Rightsize, commit, go spot —
FinOps practices that cut the bill.

ANIMATED WALKTHROUGH
Step through pages to play the animation

STEP 1/6

Visibility First: Tag Everything

You can't optimize what you can't attribute.

Tags: team, env, service, cost-center

every resource carries its owner — no orphans

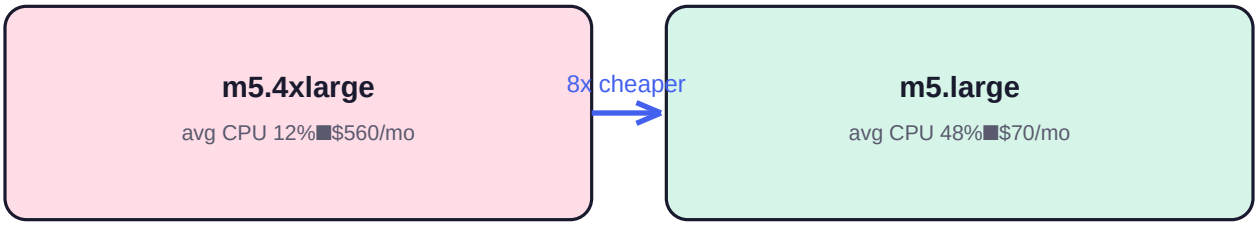
Cost allocation: 100% of spend mapped to a team. Untagged = unowned = waste.

- Enforce tagging with policy (deny untagged deploys) — voluntary tagging never sticks.
- Dashboards per team: show spend vs budget weekly, not quarterly.
- Alert on anomalies: 3x daily spend spike pages the owner, not finance.

STEP 2/6

Rightsizing: Match Shape to Load

Most instances run at 10–20% — that's the tax.

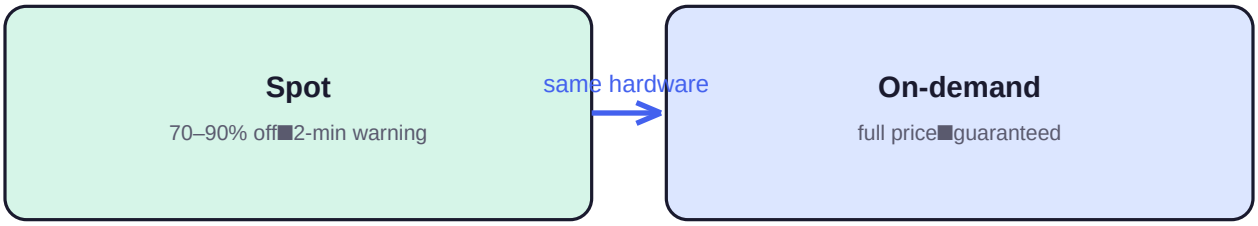


- Use recommender tools (Compute Optimizer): 2 weeks of metrics → suggested size.
- Right-size storage too: gp3 with provisioned IOPS beats over-provisioned gp2.
- Schedule non-prod: dev/staging off nights and weekends — 60%+ savings.

STEP 3/6

Spot / Preemptible: Up to 90% Off

Spare capacity at a discount — with an eviction risk.



Perfect for: batch jobs, CI runners, stateless workers, dev clusters.

- Design for interruption: checkpoint work, handle SIGTERM gracefully.
- Diversify instance types + AZs — evictions rarely hit all pools at once.
- Never spot for: single-AZ databases, stateful singletons, latency-critical paths.

STEP 4/6

Commitments: Savings Plans & RIs

Trade a 1–3 year commitment for 30–70% off steady workloads.

Commit to the BASELINE (the load you always have), keep the peaks on-demand/spot.

STEP 5/6

Kill the Idle: Storage & Sprawl

The quiet killers: unattached disks, old snapshots, zombie LBs.

Unattached volumes

deleted instance, orphaned disk still billing — snapshot then delete

Old snapshots

snapshot sprawl: keep N generations, lifecycle the rest

Idle load balancers

no targets for 30 days? it's $20/mo of nothing

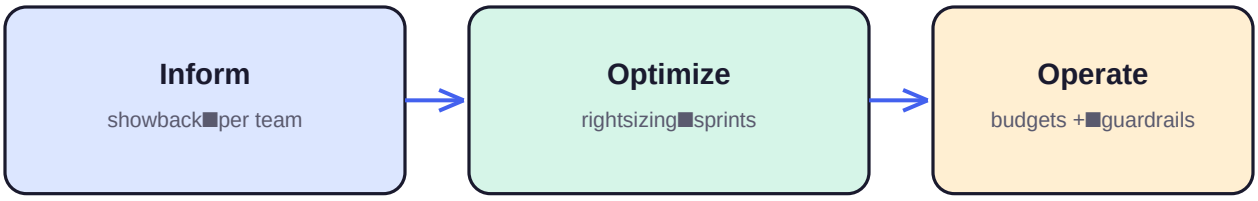
Over-retained logs

tier to cold storage or drop — logs are money

STEP 6/6

FinOps: Culture, Not Just Tools

Cost is an engineering metric — review it like latency.



Monthly FinOps review: top 10 spend drivers, waste found, commitments adjusted.

Engineers control 90% of cloud spend through architecture choices — give them the data and the incentive.

STEP ✓/✓

Key Takeaways

Cloud Cost Optimization — Remember

- Tag everything and attribute 100% of spend — visibility before optimization.
- Rightsize to actual load; schedule non-prod off; fix storage tiers.
- Spot/preemptible for fault-tolerant work (up to 90% off); commit for the steady baseline.
- Hunt idle resources monthly: orphaned disks, old snapshots, zombie load balancers.
- FinOps loop: inform (showback) → optimize (sprints) → operate (budgets).

Keep exploring

Pair this guide with the matching video walkthroughs
and hands-on labs at interstitiumlabs.dev